

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Neighbourhood map and friction count

LAND OR MARITIME BORDER -> Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Sri Lanka, Maldives

NEAR-NEIGHBOUR -> Afghanistan, adjacent after Pakistan's 1948 capture of a strip of north-western Kashmir

FRICTION RECORD -> a history of problems with six of the eight bordering states

RULE -> neighbourhood is defined by security relevance, not only by contiguity

MUST REMEMBER: Neighbourhood policy joins sovereignty, security, borders, rivers,...

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Gujral Doctrine card

PRINCIPLE 1 -> no reciprocity sought from smaller neighbours

PRINCIPLE 2 -> no interference in their internal affairs

PRINCIPLE 3 -> Indian territory not to be used against them

PRINCIPLE 4 -> respect for their territorial integrity

PRINCIPLE 5 -> bilateral and peaceful settlement of disputes

DEFINING FEATURE -> non-reciprocal accommodation, never reciprocity as a precondition

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Asymmetry to policy design

- SIZE ASYMMETRY -> India larger than the entire immediate neighbourhood combined
- > DEPENDENCE ANXIETY: smaller states prefer regional-framework engagement
- > NON-RECIPROCAL ACCOMMODATION: the doctrine answers the anxiety directly
- > CONNECTIVITY AND CREDIT: tangible public goods build confidence over time
- > TRANSITION TEST: does the benefit survive a change of government

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Neighbour-type comparison

SMALLER STATES -> Bhutan, Nepal, Maldives, Sri Lanka; greater interest in economic integration; regional framework preferred because numbers give a sense of security

LARGER OR MORE COMPLEX -> Pakistan and Bangladesh; more bilateral posture; distinct security and historical dynamics

QUALIFIER -> regional preference is reassurance, not a rejection of bilateral delivery

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Connectivity instrument ledger

1 NOVEMBER 2023 -> Akhaura-Agartala cross-border rail link inaugurated
2015 -> BBIN Motor Vehicles Agreement signed; Bhutan non-ratification constrains it
2019 / 2022 -> 720 MW Mangdechhu commissioned, then handed over to Bhutan
MAY 2023 -> Kaladan waterway and Sittwe Port operationalised; road component lagged
1 JUNE 2026 -> both sides still calling for Kaladan completion
RULE -> the gap is segment delivered against corridor completed

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Dated bilateral instrument matrix

SRI LANKA -> seven MoUs, 5 April 2025; brief current to July 2026; Sampur 120 MW had ground-breaking, not commissioning

MALDIVES -> Joint Vision 7 October 2024; FTA Terms of Reference 25 July 2025; INR 4,850 crore line of credit; brief current to June 2026

BHUTAN -> INR 100 billion for the 13th Five Year Plan 2024-29; rail MoU 29 September 2025; Gelephu Mindfulness City support 12 November 2025

LEVEL -> vision, terms of reference, memorandum and credit are pre-delivery instruments

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Sri Lanka 2022 first-responder card

BY 3 MAY 2022 -> more than USD 3 billion recorded in assistance during 2022

USD 1 billion -> facility for food, medicines and essentials

USD 500 million -> petroleum credit line; close to 400,000 tonnes of fuel delivered

ABOUT USD 1 billion -> Asian Clearing Union payment deferment

USD 400 million -> Reserve Bank of India currency swap; 25 districts covered

LIMIT -> around USD 4 billion is the full-year description; structural problems remained

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Transition-test timeline

16 AUGUST 2024 -> India engages Bangladesh's interim government

12 SEPTEMBER 2025 -> India welcomes Nepal's interim government under Sushila Karki

20 AUGUST 2025 -> India presses for early inclusive elections in Bangladesh

12 FEBRUARY 2026 -> Bangladesh parliamentary elections held

5 MARCH 2026 -> Nepal elections held

READING -> India engaged the successor arrangement in each case, not the outgoing one

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Water-security ledger

23 APRIL 2025 -> Cabinet Committee on Security holds the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance
CONDITION -> until Pakistan credibly and irrevocably abjures cross-border terrorism support
16 MAY 2026 -> India restates that the Court of Arbitration is illegally constituted
DECEMBER 2026 -> the 1996 Ganga Waters Treaty expires
13 FEBRUARY 2026 -> India states that renewal talks had not begun
DOCTRINE TEST -> non-reciprocity is least stable where the shared resource is finite

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Status distinctions that decide close options

ABEYANCE -> an executive decision on operation; expressly not treaty termination

UNDERSTANDING OF 10 MAY 2025 -> to stop all military activities; not a ceasefire agreement

EMBASSY UPGRADE OF 21 OCTOBER 2025 -> mission level changed; no recognition declaration

TERMS OF REFERENCE -> negotiations launched; not a concluded free trade agreement

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Treaty text, political understanding, project announcement, financing...

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Domestic and external constraint band

FEDERAL -> Teesta shows Indian state-level interests constraining a bilateral agreement

PARTNER POLITICS -> India must closely follow neighbouring political trends

NON-INTERFERENCE -> the Gujral principle sits in tension with that necessity

OUTSIDE POWER -> Sikri's dated critique of external guidance of South Asia policy

RULE -> cite the constraint with its date and its author, never as current fact

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Use named India-centric evidence such...

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a neighbourhood demand

OPEN -> establish structural asymmetry and the non-reciprocal doctrinal response

BUILD -> distinguish smaller-state and larger-state engagement patterns by name

TEST -> cite one dated instrument with its exact evidentiary level and its limitation

CLOSE -> apply the implementation-credibility test across a change of government